

FAMILY STUDIES

OVERVIEW

In the social sciences and humanities curriculum, family studies is a multidisciplinary subject area that encompasses four areas: fashion and housing; food and nutrition; general family studies; and raising and caring for children. The topics covered in these areas include, among others: textile production; the functions and design of clothing; the fashion industry; issues related to housing; interior design; the role of nutrition in health; the relationship between food and culture; human and family interactions and development; life management skills; various types of relationships; and considerations related to raising and caring for children.

In family studies courses, students learn about laws and policies that affect individuals and families in Canada and around the world. They also become familiar with the theoretical perspectives and practical research that underpin our understandings of individual and family development. Family studies courses also integrate theory and practical skills. Many expectations can be achieved through practical experiences both in the classroom and in co-op placements, some of which may be affiliated with Specialist High Skills Majors programs.

All courses in family studies encourage students to develop critical and creative thinking skills. Students are given opportunities to deepen their understanding of relevant issues and to develop practical skills, including research and inquiry skills. Students are encouraged to explore a range of perspectives and approaches and to develop the habits of mind that enhance individual, family, and community well-being and contribute to lifelong learning.

Exploring Family Studies, Grade 9 or 10

Open

HIF10/20

This course explores, within the context of families, some of the fundamental challenges people face: how to meet basic needs, how to relate to others, how to manage resources, and how to become responsible members of society. Students will explore adolescent development and will have opportunities to develop interpersonal, decision-making, and practical skills related to daily life. They will learn about the diverse ways in which families function in Canada and will use research skills as they explore topics related to individual and family needs and resources.

Prerequisite: None

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to individual and family needs and resources, and formulate questions to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to individual and family needs and resources (*e.g., healthy relationships, adolescent development, communication skills, lifestyle differences between generations, peer pressure, financial literacy*) to identify topics for research and inquiry
- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their selected topics
- A1.3** formulate effective questions to refine their research and inquiry
Teacher prompt: “How might you approach an investigation of anti-bullying programs? What might you look for when investigating programs aimed at elementary students? Would you look for different things in programs aimed at secondary students?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., identify sources of information, develop research tools such as surveys or questionnaires*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., informal interviews and surveys, observations, grocery bills*) and/or secondary sources (*e.g., textbooks, newspaper and magazine articles, websites, government reports*)

- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or research question, and use it to focus their research

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

- A3.1** assess various aspects of information gathered from primary and secondary sources (*e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice*)

Teacher prompts: “How can you determine whether all of the information you have gathered is relevant to your research topic?” “If two information sources contradict each other, how might you determine which is more reliable?” “What biases might there be in your information sources?”

- A3.2** record and organize information and key ideas using various formats (*e.g., notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/visual/digital records*)

A3.3 analyse and interpret research information (*e.g., compare results of surveys and interviews; determine whether common themes arise in sources*)

A3.4 demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (*e.g., weigh and connect information to determine the answer to the research question*)

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (*e.g., oral presentation, podcast, brochure, poster, report, multimedia presentation, web page*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

A4.2 use terms relating to individual and family needs and resources correctly (*e.g., abstract thinking, identity development, support, boundaries, empathy, division of labour, needs, wants, rights, resources, budget, credit card, line of credit*)

A4.3 clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (*e.g., write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow APA conventions for acknowledging sources (*e.g., generate a reference list in APA style*)

A4.4 demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills

Teacher prompt: “What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?”

B. SELF AND OTHERS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Adolescent Development:** describe important changes that are associated with adolescent development, and explain their influence on the behaviour and needs of young people;
- B2. Relating to Others:** demonstrate an understanding of various types of relationships and of skills and strategies for developing and maintaining healthy relationships;
- B3. Family Lifestyles:** describe lifestyles in diverse families and the impact of a range of factors, including social and cultural factors, on these lifestyles.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Adolescent Development

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** describe important aspects of adolescent development (*e.g., with reference to physical, cognitive, social, emotional development*)
Teacher prompts: “What physical changes occur during adolescence?” “What types of cognitive development occur during adolescence? What is meant by the term *abstract thinking*? In what areas might you use such thinking?”
- B1.2** distinguish between needs and wants, and identify needs, wants, values, and goals that may develop during adolescence (*e.g., needs/wants with respect to food, exercise, friends, support from family, electronic goods, designer clothing; values as reflected in tangible goods such as clothing and cars or intangibles such as behaviour, opinions, traits; short- and long-term goals relating to relationships, education, work, money, family*)
Teacher prompts: “Would an adolescent in Ontario today consider a cellphone or high-speed Internet access to be satisfying a want or a need? Give reasons for your answer.” “How can culture and geography affect whether something is considered to be a need or a want?” “Why is the fulfilment of some needs considered to be a human right? Which needs are referred to in the Ontario Human Rights Code and the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child?” “Do adolescents around the world have access to clean water? Is clean water a need or a want? Why?”

- B1.3** explain the connection between adolescents’ developmental needs and their individual behaviour (*e.g., how identity development and the corresponding need to belong to a group can affect social behaviours; how rapid physical development affects behaviours related to sleep and diet*)

Teacher prompts: “Have you ever felt pressured by your peers to engage in behaviour that you were uncomfortable with? Have you ever expressed opinions you didn’t hold in order to be accepted by or fit in better with a group? What do you think accounts for this type of behaviour?” “What are some ways in which classroom practices might be modified to recognize adolescent developmental needs?”

B2. Relating to Others

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** describe various types of relationships in which adolescents are involved (*e.g., relationships with family, friends, and people in the local community; collegial, intimate, and sexual relationships*)
Teacher prompts: “What is meant by the term *universe of obligation*? What relationships are in your universe of obligation?” “If there is a conflict between the needs of your friends and the needs of your family, to whom do you feel the most obligation? Why?” “What types of attitudes and behaviour are necessary for you to ‘be there’ for your family? For your family to ‘be there’ for you?”

B2.2 describe the characteristics of healthy and unhealthy relationships (e.g., healthy relationships: *trust, mutual support, clear limits and boundaries, humour, honesty*; unhealthy relationships: *mistrust, jealousy, isolation, control, tension*)

Teacher prompts: “What rewards do we experience from healthy relationships?” “How do you know when a relationship is unhealthy?”

B2.3 identify resources and strategies that can be used to help develop healthy relationships and resolve conflict in a variety of human interactions (e.g., *assertiveness training, anti-bullying programs, strategies for developing empathy*)

B2.4 describe and demonstrate socially appropriate verbal and non-verbal communication skills in a variety of situations (e.g., *describe the importance of maintaining eye contact when talking with a friend; show respect for the opinions of others in classroom discussions; using role play, demonstrate how to listen attentively when talking with parents or caregivers, or how to speak confidently during a job interview*)

B3. Family Lifestyles

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 describe the impact of change, including social, economic, technological, and environmental change, on the lifestyles of past and present families (e.g., *the effects of changes in divorce rates, the participation of women in the workforce, the role of fathers, gender roles, household technology; generational shifts in parental*

perceptions about appropriate levels of involvement with and protection of children; the impact of resource depletion on families who live on the land; the rise of the skills-based economy)

Teacher prompts: “What impact have changes in technology had on household labour in Ontario?” “In what ways are current family lifestyles different from those of past generations? Have lifestyles changed equally for rural, urban, suburban, and reserve families? Why or why not?” “What impact have economic and technological changes had on people’s recreational time? How have these changes affected the extent to which people spend time outside, in nature?”

B3.2 describe differences in lifestyle among families from diverse backgrounds (e.g., *food choices; social life; gender roles; family celebrations and traditions; views on health and wellness; religious expression*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways can social interactions between friends be affected by the ethnocultural, socio-economic, racial, linguistic, and/or faith backgrounds of their respective families?” “What impact do religious observances such as Ramadan or Shabbat have on the behaviour of observant families?” “What differences in leisure time pursuits or the division of labour would you expect to see in a working-class family and an upper-middle-class family?” “How might Aboriginal families living in urban locations and those living on reserves differ in their approach to family and community traditions?”

C. DAILY LIVING SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Decision Making and Problem Solving:** demonstrate the ability to apply decision-making and problem-solving strategies and skills, particularly within a family context;
- C2. Managing Resources:** demonstrate an understanding of strategies and skills that can be used to manage resources to meet the needs of the family and its individual members;
- C3. Practical Skills:** demonstrate an understanding of practical skills and knowledge needed to safely and effectively perform day-to-day tasks that help meet their needs and those of the family.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Decision Making and Problem Solving

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify and use effective decision-making strategies (*e.g., identify effective decision-making models, reflect on the results of past decisions*) to make sound decisions related to their own well-being and that of their family

Teacher prompts: “What kinds of decisions are suited to an intuitive rather than a rational decision-making model?” “How can reflecting on past decisions help you make future decisions that would be in your best interests?”

- C1.2** demonstrate individual and collaborative problem-solving skills that could be applied in situations involving family, peers, or members of the community (*e.g., to resolve a disagreement with a parent, when participating in a group project, when preparing for a difficult test, to resist peer pressure*)

Teacher prompts: “How could you use role play to demonstrate strategies for resolving conflicts with family members?” “What sorts of skills would you need in order to work with a group to plan a meal?” “How do some families use humour to alleviate stress or conflict between family members?” “What skills might elders use in bringing families together?”

C2. Managing Resources

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** identify family resources (*e.g., time, knowledge, money, skills, talents*) and describe how they can be used to meet the needs of the family unit and its individual members

Teacher prompts: “What are some situations in which skills and talent can be used instead of money to accomplish household tasks?” “If you could have plenty of money or plenty of time but not both, which would you choose? Why?”

- C2.2** apply effective strategies for managing time to achieve individual, family, and group goals (*e.g., prioritizing; setting daily, weekly, and monthly goals; clearly communicating divisions of labour within a family or group; identifying resources needed to achieve goals and organizing them logically with respect to time considerations*)

Teacher prompts: “In your family, how does the availability and allocation of time affect the ability of family members to achieve their goals?” “What are the sources of time pressures in your family? Is it possible to alleviate these pressures?” “What strategies are used in your family to manage time effectively? What other strategies could you suggest to manage time more effectively?” “How could you work with a group to organize the time and tasks needed to accomplish a group goal such as designing a bulletin board in the classroom or a display case in the hall?”

C2.3 describe and demonstrate financial strategies and the financial literacy skills necessary to manage financial resources to meet personal and family financial goals (e.g., *create a budget, develop personal banking skills, save for a major purchase, regulate credit card use*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the advantages and challenges of setting aside money regularly to save for a purchase?” “Why is saving money not possible for some people?” “How can you get the services that you need from a bank while avoiding service charges?” “How is a credit card different from a line of credit? Under what circumstances is it more financially sound to use a line of credit rather than a credit card?”

C2.4 identify resources within their community that are available to support the needs of individuals and families (e.g., *parks and playgrounds; libraries; recreation centres; walk-in clinics and hospitals; food banks; employment services; phone lines, websites, and centres to help teens*)

C3. Practical Skills

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 describe and demonstrate appropriate procedures that contribute to household safety (e.g., *safe procedures for working with household chemicals and kitchen appliances, preparing and storing food, sewing, communicating with others on the Internet, caring for young children; what to do in case of fire; precautions to ensure their personal safety when they are home alone*)

C3.2 describe the elements of a healthy diet, and demonstrate the practical knowledge and skills required to prepare healthy meals and snacks (e.g., *the ability to plan varied, nutritious, and economical meals and snacks; an understanding of healthy cooking methods; an understanding of the guidelines in Canada’s Food Guide, including the First Nations, Inuit, and Métis version and the translated versions of Canada’s Food Guide; the ability to follow recipes and to interpret food labels; skills related to food presentation*)

C3.3 describe criteria used in wardrobe planning, and demonstrate the practical knowledge and skills required to meet their clothing needs (e.g., *an understanding of apparel and textile care symbols; the ability to care for clothing made from various types of fabric, to choose a practical and affordable wardrobe, to mend a garment, to construct and/or alter a garment, to locate budget and second-hand clothing stores*)

C3.4 describe factors that can affect the design of living spaces, and demonstrate the practical knowledge and skills required to help create and sustain a healthy and functional living space (e.g., *the ability to choose environmentally friendly technology and materials, to decorate on a budget, to apply elements and principles of design, to construct a home accessory from new or recycled components*)

D. EXERCISING RESPONSIBILITY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Personal Responsibilities:** demonstrate an understanding of their responsibilities related to their personal well-being and that of their family, and of how they can maintain their health and well-being;
- D2. Family Responsibilities:** describe the functions and responsibilities of families and the diverse ways in which families fulfil them;
- D3. Consumer Awareness:** describe and demonstrate responsible consumer practices.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Personal Responsibilities

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** identify strategies and resources that individuals can use to improve and/or maintain their personal health and well-being (*e.g., resources such as Canada's Food Guide and other Health Canada publications; strategies such as practising good hygiene, exercising, spending time in nature, managing stress, choosing healthy foods, living within their means, fostering healthy relationships; avoiding unsafe practices such as drinking and driving, smoking, having unprotected sex*)
- D1.2** explain the importance of taking personal responsibility for maintaining their health and well-being (*e.g., how taking personal responsibility contributes to skills development, independence, self-confidence*)
- D1.3** explain how and why an adolescent's responsibilities with respect to the family and household changes as his or her independence increases (*e.g., with reference to sharing responsibilities to meet food, clothing, and household needs, and caring for and communicating with family members*)

D2. Family Responsibilities

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** describe a variety of family forms (*e.g., nuclear, single-parent, blended, extended, same-sex, skipped-generation, foster, and adoptive families; families of affinity*)

- D2.2** identify family functions that are common to all cultures (*e.g., reproduction, socialization of children, physical maintenance of members, nurturance and love, social control, production of goods and services*)

- D2.3** describe ways in which diverse families (*e.g., families from diverse backgrounds, nuclear versus extended families, upper-class versus working-class families*) perform their fundamental functions

Teacher prompts: "How might same-sex parents involve other adults in their children's lives to provide diverse role models for their children?" "How might families with no children of their own contribute to the socialization of children?" "Under what circumstances might a family need to go to a food bank?" "What are some childcare options for parents who work outside the home?" "What is the role of foster families or organizations such as Big Brothers/Sisters?" "How might day-to-day life for members of a single-parent family be different from that for the members of an extended family?" "What impact has the Indian Act had on the ability of Aboriginal parents to perform their functions within the family (*e.g., with respect to educating children, passing on religious and spiritual practices, maintaining Aboriginal languages*)?"

- D2.4** explain how families can fulfil their functions and meet their needs while reducing their impact on the environment (*e.g., by recycling and reusing goods, composting, shopping for second-hand clothing or household items, reducing consumption, using forms of transportation other than a car whenever possible*)

D3. Consumer Awareness

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 describe strategies for making informed and responsible consumer decisions (*e.g., comparison shopping, reading labels and contracts, buying Canadian-made goods, checking warranties*)

Teacher prompts: “When shopping for a cellphone, why is it important to read the contract before you make a purchase?” “Why is it important to consider where our food is grown and where products are made? How can buying locally grown foods decrease our environmental footprint?”

D3.2 describe the impact of marketing and advertising techniques (*e.g., product placement, celebrity endorsement*) on consumer decisions

Teacher prompt: “What marketing and advertising strategies are used most frequently with adolescents? Why is ‘coolhunting’ a frequently used marketing strategy for products directed at the adolescent market?”

D3.3 describe strategies for resisting impulse buying (*e.g., make a list of the items they need, eat before going grocery shopping, plan their purchases, research the product they want*)

Teacher prompts: “Why should you avoid grocery shopping on an empty stomach?” “Why is it important to ensure that you can return a purchase before buying a product?”

D3.4 create a plan for making a major purchase (*e.g., buying a computer, signing up for a cellphone package*), using strategies for making informed and responsible consumer decisions

Teacher prompts: “Where would you find reliable information about a product you want to buy?” “What criteria can be used to judge whether a purchase is a responsible one?”